

One World, Different School Years

Name: _____ Class: _____

Does every school year start in September? No. School calendars are different. The country, the school and the season all matter.

Japan

In Japan, the school year starts in April, in spring. It ends in late March. Summer vacation is in the middle of the school year. At many schools, it lasts approximately six weeks, from late July to the end of August.

Alaska and Florida

Even in one country, schools follow different calendars. In Anchorage, Alaska, Grade 7 starts on August 20 in 2026 and finishes on May 28 in 2027. Its next summer vacation is about eleven weeks. In Miami-Dade, Florida, school starts on August 13 in 2026 and ends on June 3 in 2027. For a summer example, the 2026 vacation is about ten weeks.

England

According to the Kent calendar, the 2026 school year starts in September and ends in July 2027. The summer holiday lasts almost six weeks. Individual schools also have days for teacher training.

The United Arab Emirates

In UAE public schools, the year starts on August 31 in 2026 and ends on July 2 in 2027. Summer vacation lasts a little more than eight weeks. Students return on August 30.

A Small Island

Jersey is a small island where English is the main language. Its 2026–27 calendar runs from September to July. The summer break is nearly seven weeks, before extra teacher-training days. A small island has its own school calendar, too.

Seasons and School

April brings a new school year in Japan. In the other examples, students begin in August or September. Summer vacation and the end of a school year are not always the same event.

Find and explain

1. Where does the school year begin in spring? _____
2. Is Japan's summer vacation at the end of its school year? Explain.

Calendar scope: local examples, not one calendar for every school in a country. Florida's summer example is 2026; other dated summer examples are 2027. Holiday lengths include weekends. See the linked School Calendars page for official sources.

One Sea. One Snowstorm.

A Snow Day, a Screen and a Shovel

It is November 9, 2023. A snowstorm makes the roads in Anchorage dangerous. Kali cannot go to school today. Her teacher reads a story to the class online, from his couch. The book is about a snowy day! Kali misses school and finds online learning harder. She also goes outside to clear snow from the driveway. She wants to earn some money.

Source: KTUU / Alaska's News Source, 10 November 2023

The School Boat

Zoe and Isaac live on Bryher, a small island. Their school is on nearby Tresco. Every morning, they meet the other children at the place where the boat stops. The boat journey takes only five minutes. Sometimes they see dolphins. After the boat arrives, they walk to school. For these children, going to class means crossing the sea.

Source: BBC Teach, Life on the Isles of Scilly, 2024

Read closely

1. What stops Kali from travelling to school? Give a detail from the text.

2. Why do Zoe and Isaac need a boat? How long does their boat journey take?

3. Do the island children always see dolphins? Which word tells you?

4. Compare the two school days. Write one difference and use evidence from both texts.

Routines, Questions and Meaning

A. Choose the form that fits.

1. I (carry / carries) my bag to school.
2. Samuel's brothers (help / helps) him.
3. The boat (stop / stops) near the island.
4. Kali (do not / does not) go to school on this snow day.
5. Carlito does not (walk / walks) the whole way.

B. Ask and answer.

1. Write a question with How: Carlito goes to school by horse.

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2. Write a question with When: The bike bus travels on Fridays.

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3. Ask a partner about the journey to school. Write your question and the answer.
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C. Find the meaning in context.

Circle the meaning that fits each sentence.

1. The nearby station is open.
A. close to this place B. far away
2. The kitchen is on fire.
A. cooking food on a grill B. burning
3. We offer our thanks to the teacher.
A. our expressions of gratitude B. a reason something happens
4. He bought a new ski.
A. the action of skiing B. one long piece of equipment

D. Use it.

Choose nearby or on fire. Write a new sentence that makes its meaning clear.

My School Routine

Listen first

Play “A Snow Day, a Screen and a Shovel” from the unit’s Listen First page. Keep the reading page closed. Listen once for the main idea and again for details.

Who? _____ Where? _____

What changes that day?

Where is the teacher during the online lesson? _____

Why does Kali clear the snow? _____

Plan your writing

Write 50–70 words about your school routine. Include how you travel, one negative sentence, one frequency word and two vocabulary entries from groups 03–05. Connect ideas with and, but or because.

My two vocabulary entries: _____ / _____

An idea I want my reader to understand:

My paragraph

Check and revise

Check your meaning first. Then check Present Simple, your negative sentence and spelling. Underline your two vocabulary entries. Improve one sentence after feedback.

Teacher: assess the message, supporting details and independent use of language. Completing a page alone does not establish vocabulary mastery.